
Re: Urgent concerns regarding proposed data center in Callaway County MO

From Christopher Scott <cscott@callawaycounty.org>

Date Tue 5/26/2026 9:53 AM

To April Backer <april.backer75@gmail.com>

I appreciate you taking the time to send your email. Please know that you have been heard. If you would like to discuss further, I would welcome either a telephone discussion or an in-person chat. My contact info is all available in the email signature below.

Christopher Scott

Callaway County Commission

Western District

10 East 5th Street Fulton, MO 65251

573-642-0737 (Office)

573-418-4561 (Mobile)

573-642-1032 (Fax)

cscott@callawaycounty.org



Callaway County

Celebrating 200 years in the heart of Mid Missouri

From: April Backer <april.backer75@gmail.com>

Sent: Monday, May 25, 2026 6:09 PM

To: Christopher Scott <cscott@callawaycounty.org>

Subject: Urgent concerns regarding proposed data center in Callaway County MO

Dear Commissioner Scott,

I am a resident of rural Callaway County and I am writing to formally express my opposition to the proposed data center project in Callaway County, unless proper protections for the community are in place. While I support economic development, I believe AI data centers and similar business projects present significant risks to our community that must be properly mitigated.

My concerns include:

1. Environmental Impact: The potential for excessive water consumption and noise pollution from cooling systems and generators.
2. Grid Reliability: The immense energy demands could cause utility rates to rise for local residents.

3. Land Use: This project does not align with the rural/residential character of our area, disrupting agricultural land and local wildlife.

While these facilities provide tax revenue, they are intense industrial users that require careful regulation to be "good neighbors". At a minimum, please consider the following when evaluating new proposals:

- * Mandating noise mitigation: Restricting chiller operations to meet noise limits at property lines.
- * Environmental Protection: Prohibiting projects in floodplains or areas with high water tables, and regulating water and electric usage such that it does not impact the availability or costs of these basic utilities for the citizens of the surrounding communities.
- * Thermal Pollution Study: Evaluating the impact of "heat domes" on surrounding agriculture.

At minimum, I urge the commission to institute a moratorium to conduct a comprehensive impact study before approving any such project.

Sincerely,
April Backer
6850 County Rd 116, Fulton, MO 65251